

Absolutely — **even** is a very strong target because its occurrence in your passage is an **adverb of emphasis**, while the same spelling also functions as an **adjective** and **verb** with several important modern meanings.

# Word family: **even / evenly / evenness / uneven / unevenly / unevenness / even-handed**

**Base word:** even

**Related forms:** evenly, evenness, uneven, unevenly, unevenness

**Useful family extension:** even-handed

**Part of speech:** adverb ( 副詞 ) / adjective ( 形容詞 ) / verb ( 動詞 )

Your sentence:

> “I first met him when I was in junior secondary school, and **even now** I can still remember the atmosphere in his classroom very clearly.”

The governing polysemy rule here is to separate genuinely different concepts, while keeping construction-based variations together when they share the same underlying meaning.

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# Meaning in your passage: **even now** = surprisingly/still at the present time — 即使到了現在；甚至現在仍然

Here, **even** adds emphasis.

It signals that:

> **a long time has passed, so remembering the classroom atmosphere this clearly might be considered surprising — but it is still true now.**

**繁體中文：**

**強調某件事到了目前這麼晚的時間點仍然成立，而這一點具有出乎意料、值得強調的意味**

Natural translation:

> “...and even now I can still remember the atmosphere in his classroom very clearly.”

「而且**即使到了現在 / 直到現在**，我仍然**很清楚**記得他課堂上的那種氣氛。」

Here:

> **even now** = 即使到了現在這個時間點，情況仍然如此

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# 1. \*\*even + emphasized word/phrase ( 出乎意料 / 極端例子 ) — 甚至 ; 連.....也\*\*

This is the broad adverbial meaning behind your original sentence.

**Meaning:** Used to highlight something as surprising, extreme, unlikely, or especially noteworthy.

#### ### Practice 1 — Original

> “\*\*Even now\*\*, I can still remember the atmosphere in his classroom.”

「\*\*即使到了現在 / 直到現在\*\*，我仍然記得他課堂上的氣氛。」

#### ### Practice 2

> “\*\*Even the weakest students\*\* enjoyed his lessons.”

「\*\*甚至連能力較弱的學生\*\*也喜歡他的課堂。」

#### ### Practice 3

> “He could make \*\*even difficult topics\*\* interesting.”

「他\*\*甚至能把很難的題目\*\*講得有趣。」

**even = 把某個人、事物、時間或情況標示為特別意外、極端或值得強調的例子**

This is the central adverbial sense.

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# 2. \*\*even now / then / today / after... ( 時間強調 ) — 即使到了.....仍然 ; 甚至在.....時\*\*

This is a contextual branch of #1, not a separate lexical meaning.

#### ### Practice 4

> “\*\*Even today\*\*, people still discuss his teaching methods.”

「\*\*即使到了今天\*\*，人們仍然會討論他的教學方法。」

#### ### Practice 5

> “\*\*Even after twenty years\*\*, she remembered his advice.”

「\*\*即使過了二十年\*\*，她仍然記得他的忠告。」

**\*\*even + time expression = 強調到了某個時間點，某件原本可能預期已經改變 / 消失的事情仍然成立\*\***

This is exactly what happens in your passage.

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# 3. **\*\*even + comparative ( 比較級 ) — 更加；甚至更.....\*\***

A very important grammatical use.

#### Practice 6

> “His second lesson was **\*\*even more interesting\*\***.”

「他的第二堂課**\*\*更加有趣\*\***。」

#### Practice 7

> “The question became **\*\*even harder\*\***.”

「這條問題變得**\*\*更加困難\*\***。」

**\*\*even + comparative = 在原本已存在的程度上再進一步加強；甚至更.....\*\***

Common:

- \* even better
- \* even worse
- \* even more difficult
- \* even less likely
- \* even bigger

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# 4. **\*\*even if + clause ( 讓步假設 ) — 即使；就算\*\***

This is an important construction.

#### Practice 8

> “**\*\*Even if\*\*** the exam is difficult, I will try my best.”

「**\*\*即使\*\***考試很難，我也會盡力。」

#### Practice 9

> “I would respect him **even if** I disagreed with him.”

「**即使**我不同意他的看法，我仍然會尊重他。」

**even if** = 即使某個假設情況成立，主句的結果仍然不改變

The condition may be hypothetical.

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# 5. **even though** + clause ( 讓步事實 ) — 雖然；儘管

Very important contrast with **even if**.

### Practice 10

> “**Even though** he was strict, the students respected him.”

「**雖然**他很嚴格，學生仍然尊重他。」

### Practice 11

> “She attended class **even though** she was tired.”

「她**儘管**很累，仍然去上課。」

**even though** = 承認一個真實存在的事實，但指出主句結果仍然成立

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## Critical distinction: **even if** vs **even though**

### **even if**

= hypothetical possibility

> “Even if it rains, we will go.”

「即使下雨，我們也會去。」

Rain may or may not happen.

### **even though**

= known fact

> “Even though it was raining, we went.”

「雖然當時正在下雨，我們還是去了。」

Rain actually happened.

This is excellent MCQ material.

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# 6. \*\*even so = despite that / nevertheless — 即使如此；儘管這樣\*\*

A useful fixed expression.

### Practice 12

> “The lesson was difficult. \*\*Even so\*\*, I enjoyed it.”

「那堂課很難。即使如此 / 儘管如此，我仍然很喜歡。」

### Practice 13

> “He was very strict. \*\*Even so\*\*, the students trusted him.”

「他很嚴格。即使如此，學生仍然信任他。」

\*\*even so = 前面的情況雖然可能導致相反結果，但實際結果仍然成立\*\*

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# 7. \*\*even = flat / level / smooth ( 表面 ) — 平坦的；平整的\*\*

Now \*\*even\*\* is an adjective and the mental concept changes completely.

### Practice 14

> “Make sure the table is on an \*\*even surface\*\*.”

「確保桌子放在平坦的表面上。」

### Practice 15

> “The floor is not completely \*\*even\*\*.”

「地板並不是完全平整的。」

**\*\*even — surface = 高低一致，沒有明顯凹凸或傾斜的\*\***

This is genuinely different from adverbial **\*\*even = 甚至\*\***.

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# 8. **\*\*even = equal / balanced ( 數量 / 程度 / 雙方 ) — 相等的；均衡的；勢均力敵的\*\***

Another major adjective meaning.

#### ### Practice 16

> “Divide the students into two **\*\*even groups\*\***.”

「把學生分成兩個人數**\*\*相等的組別\*\***。」

#### ### Practice 17

> “The two teams were fairly **\*\*even\*\***.”

「兩支球隊的實力相當**\*\*接近 / 勢均力敵\*\***。」

**\*\*even = 數量、力量、程度或條件大致相同，沒有一方明顯較多 / 較強\*\***

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# 9. **\*\*an even chance ( 概率 ) — 相等機會；五五波\*\***

A contextual branch of equal/balanced **\*\*even\*\***.

#### ### Practice 18

> “There is an **\*\*even chance\*\*** that either team will win.”

「兩隊獲勝的機會**\*\*各佔一半 / 差不多相等\*\***。」

#### ### Practice 19

> “We have an **\*\*even chance\*\*** of success.”

「我們成功的機會大約是**\*\*五五開 / 一半一半\*\***。」

**\*\*even chance = 兩種可能性的機會大致相等\*\***

Usually:

> roughly 50–50.

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# 10. \*\*even = regular / consistent ( 速度 / 聲音 / 分布 ) — 均勻的 ; 平穩的 ; 規律的\*\*

This is related to balance, but useful enough to distinguish contextually.

#### ### Practice 20

> “He spoke in a calm, \*\*even voice\*\*.”

「他用平靜而\*\*平穩的聲線\*\*說話。」

#### ### Practice 21

> “Try to keep an \*\*even pace\*\*.”

「盡量保持\*\*穩定而均勻的步伐 / 速度\*\*。」

\*\*even = 在不同時間 / 位置保持相近程度，沒有突然大幅變化的\*\*

Common:

- \* even pace
- \* even rhythm
- \* even tone
- \* even pressure
- \* even distribution

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# 11. \*\*even = calm / controlled ( 情緒 / 性格 ) — 平和的 ; 情緒穩定的\*\*

This develops from the “steady, without fluctuation” meaning.

#### ### Practice 22

> “She remained \*\*even-tempered\*\* under pressure.”

「她在壓力下仍然保持\*\*性情平和、情緒穩定\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 23

> “His manner remained calm and \*\*even\*\*.”

「他的態度一直保持平靜而\*\*穩定\*\*。」

**even — temperament** = 情緒不容易劇烈起伏，能保持冷靜穩定的

This is less common as bare **even** than in compounds such as **even-tempered**, but it is still useful.

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# 12. **even number ( 數學 ) — 偶數的**

A major mathematical meaning.

### Practice 24

> “Six is an **even number**.”

「六是**偶數**。」

### Practice 25

> “Write down all the **even numbers** between 1 and 10.”

「寫出 1 至 10 之間所有的**偶數**。」

**even number** = 能被 2 整除而沒有餘數的整數

Opposite:

> **odd number** = 奇數

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# 13. **even = equal score / tied ( 比分 ) — 平手的；打成平局的**

A sports/game extension of “equal.”

### Practice 26

> “The score was **even** at 2–2.”

「比分是 2 比 2，雙方**打成平手**。」

### Practice 27

> “The match remained **even** until the final minute.”

「比賽直到最後一分鐘仍然**勢均力敵 / 不分勝負**。」

**even — score = 雙方分數或競爭位置相同，沒有一方領先**

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# 14. **even + something ( 動詞 ) — 使相等；使均衡；使平整**

Now **even** becomes a verb.

### Practice 28

> “The worker **evened** the surface before painting.”

「工人在油漆前先把表面**弄平整**。」

### Practice 29

> “The final goal **evened** the score.”

「最後一球把比分**扳平了**。」

**even — verb = 使原本不平、不相等或不均衡的東西變得平整 / 相等**

The exact Chinese depends on context:

\* even a surface → 弄平

\* even the score → 扳平比分

\* even the distribution → 使分布更均勻

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# 15. **evenly = in equal amounts / uniformly — 均勻地；平均地**

The main adverb derived from adjective **even**.

### Practice 30

> “Spread the paint **evenly** across the wall.”

「把油漆**均勻地**塗在牆上。」

### Practice 31

> “The money was divided **evenly** among the students.”

「那筆錢在學生之間**平均分配**。」

**evenly** = 各部分的數量、分布或程度相近，沒有某一部分特別多 / 少

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# 16. **evenly** = calmly / steadily ( 說話 / 呼吸 ) — 平穩地；均勻地

Same underlying “regularity” idea.

#### ### Practice 32

> “She breathed slowly and **evenly**.”

「她緩慢而**平穩地**呼吸。」

#### ### Practice 33

> “He spoke **evenly** despite his anger.”

「儘管他很生氣，仍然**語氣平穩地**說話。」

**evenly** = 以沒有明顯波動、起伏或突然變化的方式

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# 17. **evenness** = equality / regularity / smoothness — 均勻；平整；平衡程度

#### ### Practice 34

> “Check the **evenness** of the surface.”

「檢查表面的**平整程度**。」

#### ### Practice 35

> “The **evenness** of the lighting made the room easier to photograph.”

「光線的**均勻程度**令房間更容易拍攝。」

**evenness** = 某物保持平整、均勻、平衡或一致的程度 / 特質

The exact Chinese changes with context.

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# 18. \*\*uneven = not level / not equal / not regular — 不平的；不均勻的；不平均的\*\*

A very important opposite family member.

Rather than split every context artificially, we can unify them under:

> \*\*lacking the equality, smoothness, regularity, or consistency expected\*\*

#### Practice 36

> “The ground was rough and \*\*uneven\*\*.”

「地面粗糙而且\*\*凹凸不平\*\*。」

#### Practice 37

> “The quality of the students’ work was \*\*uneven\*\*.”

「學生作品的質素\*\*參差不齊 / 不一致\*\*。」

\*\*uneven = 在高度、數量、分布、質素或表現方面不一致、不均衡的\*\*

Contextual Chinese:

\* uneven road → 凹凸不平

\* uneven distribution → 分布不均

\* uneven performance → 表現不穩 / 參差

\* uneven quality → 質素參差

Same underlying concept.

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# 19. \*\*unevenly = irregularly / unequally — 不均勻地；不平均地\*\*

#### Practice 38

> “The paint was applied \*\*unevenly\*\*.”

「油漆塗得\*\*不均勻\*\*。」

#### Practice 39

> “The benefits were distributed \*\*unevenly\*\*.”

「利益的分配\*\*並不平均\*\*。」

**\*\*unevenly = 不同部分所得的數量、程度或分布並不一致\*\***

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# 20. **\*\*unevenness = lack of consistency/equality — 不均勻；不平整；參差\*\***

#### ### Practice 40

> “The road’s **\*\*unevenness\*\*** made driving uncomfortable.”

「路面的**\*\*凹凸不平\*\***令駕駛變得不舒服。」

#### ### Practice 41

> “Critics noted the **\*\*unevenness\*\*** of the film.”

「評論者指出這部電影的質素**\*\*參差不齊\*\***。」

**\*\*unevenness = 缺乏平整、均衡、一致或穩定的狀態\*\***

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# 21. **\*\*even-handed = fair and impartial — 公正的；不偏不倚的\*\***

This is a genuinely useful family extension.

#### ### Practice 42

> “The teacher was strict but **\*\*even-handed\*\***.”

「老師很嚴格，但處事**\*\*公正、不偏不倚\*\***。」

#### ### Practice 43

> “The report gives an **\*\*even-handed\*\*** account of both sides.”

「這份報告對雙方作出了**\*\*公平而不偏頗的描述\*\***。」

**\*\*even-handed = 對不同人士 / 立場採取相同標準，不偏袒任何一方的\*\***

This connects conceptually to:

> **\*\*even = balanced/equal\*\***

but it is its own lexicalized compound.

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## Important distinction: **even** vs **still**

Your original sentence contains both:

> “**even** now I can **still** remember...”

They do different jobs.

### **even** now

adds surprise/emphasis:

**即使到了現在這個很晚的時間點**

### **still**

expresses continuation:

**某個情況從過去一直持續到現在**

So:

> “Even now I can still remember it.”

means roughly:

> **「即使已經過了這麼久，直到現在我仍然記得。」**

The two words reinforce different aspects:

\* **even** → surprising/emphatic point

\* **still** → continuing state

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## Important distinction: **even** vs **also**

Both can sometimes translate as 「也」, but their meanings differ.

### **also**

simply adds another item.

> “He also taught geography.”

「他也教地理。」

### \*\*even\*\*

adds something surprising/extreme.

> “He even taught university-level material.”

「他甚至教大學程度的內容。」

So:

\*\*also = 另外也.....\*\*

\*\*even = 甚至連.....也.....\*\*

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## Important distinction: \*\*even vs only\*\*

They often pull focus in opposite directions.

### \*\*even\*\*

adds an unexpectedly extreme member:

> “Even beginners understood.”

「甚至初學者也明白。」

### \*\*only\*\*

restricts the group:

> “Only beginners understood.”

「只有初學者明白。」

One word completely reverses the implication.

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## Important distinction: \*\*even vs flat\*\*

For surfaces:

### \*\*even\*\*

= level / without irregularities

### \*\*flat\*\*

= not curved/sloping significantly

A surface may be:

> flat but uneven

For example, a generally horizontal floor with small bumps.

So:

**\*\*flat = 整體平的\*\***

**\*\*even = 各部分高低一致、沒有明顯凹凸\*\***

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## Important distinction: **\*\*even vs equal\*\***

### **\*\*equal\*\***

strongly emphasizes identical quantity/value/status.

### **\*\*even\*\***

often means balanced or approximately equal in distribution/competition.

> “Two equal amounts.”

「兩個相等的數量。」

> “The teams are evenly matched.”

「兩隊實力相若、勢均力敵。」

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## Important distinction: **\*\*even vs steady\*\***

### \*\*even\*\*

= regular, without substantial variation.

### \*\*steady\*\*

= stable and continuing without sudden change.

They overlap:

> even breathing

> steady breathing

But \*\*even\*\* particularly emphasizes \*\*uniformity\*\*, while \*\*steady\*\* emphasizes \*\*stability/continuity\*\*.

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## Important distinction: \*\*even vs odd — mathematics\*\*

### \*\*even\*\*

= divisible by 2

### \*\*odd\*\*

= not divisible by 2

Examples:

\* 2, 4, 6 → even

\* 1, 3, 5 → odd

Do not confuse mathematical \*\*odd\*\* with:

> odd = strange

which is another polysemy family of its own.

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# Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

\* \*\*even — emphasis\*\* = 甚至 ; 連.....也

\* \*\*even now/today/after...\*\* = 即使到了.....仍然  
 \* \*\*even + comparative\*\* = 更加 / 甚至更.....  
 \* \*\*even if\*\* = 即使 / 就算  
 \* \*\*even though\*\* = 雖然 / 儘管  
 \* \*\*even so\*\* = 即使如此 / 儘管如此  
 \* \*\*even — surface\*\* = 平整的  
 \* \*\*even — equal/balanced\*\* = 相等 / 均衡的  
 \* \*\*even chance\*\* = 機會相等 / 五五波  
 \* \*\*even — regular/steady\*\* = 均勻 / 平穩的  
 \* \*\*even number\*\* = 偶數  
 \* \*\*even — tied score\*\* = 平手 / 打平  
 \* \*\*even — verb\*\* = 使平整 / 使相等  
 \* \*\*evenly\*\* = 均勻地 / 平均地 / 平穩地  
 \* \*\*evenness\*\* = 平整 / 均勻 / 一致程度  
 \* \*\*uneven\*\* = 不平 / 不均 / 參差  
 \* \*\*unevenly\*\* = 不均勻地 / 不平均地  
 \* \*\*unevenness\*\* = 不均勻 / 參差狀態  
 \* \*\*even-handed\*\* = 公平、不偏不倚的

I would stop there rather than add every predictable **even-** compound. The family is already semantically rich without turning it into a dictionary dump, which matches the Golden Manual's "search broadly, split conservatively" standard.

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#### # Master comparison

| Form / sense                   | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning      |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| -----                          | -----                                      |
| <b>even — emphasis</b>         | 把某個人、事物、時間或情況標示為特別意外、極端或值得強調的；甚至 / 連.....也 |
| <b>even now/today/after...</b> | 強調到了某個時間點，某件可能預期已改變的事情仍然成立                 |
| <b>even + comparative</b>      | 在原有程度上進一步加強；更加 / 甚至更.....                  |
| <b>even if</b>                 | 即使某個假設情況成立，主句結果仍然不改變                       |
| <b>even though</b>             | 承認某個真實事實存在，但主句結果仍然成立                       |
| <b>even so</b>                 | 前述情況雖可能導致相反結果，但實際結果仍然如此                    |
| <b>even — surface</b>          | 高低一致、沒有明顯凹凸或傾斜的                            |
| <b>even — equal/balanced</b>   | 數量、力量、程度或條件大致相同，沒有一方明顯佔優                   |
| <b>even chance</b>             | 兩種結果的可能性大致相等                               |
| <b>even — regular/steady</b>   | 各時間 / 位置的程度相近，沒有突然或明顯波動的                   |
| <b>even number</b>             | 能被 2 整除而沒有餘數的整數                            |
| <b>even — score</b>            | 雙方比分相同或競爭實力相若，沒有一方領先                       |
| <b>even — verb</b>             | 使原本不平、不相等或不均衡的東西變得平整 / 相等                  |
| <b>evenly</b>                  | 以各部分數量、程度或分布相近的方式                          |
| <b>evenness</b>                | 保持平整、均衡、規律或一致的程度 / 特質                      |
| <b>uneven</b>                  | 在高度、數量、分布、質素或表現方面不一致 / 不均衡的                |

|                        |                         |  |
|------------------------|-------------------------|--|
| <b>**unevenly**</b>    | 不同部分的數量、程度或分布不一致地       |  |
| <b>**unevenness**</b>  | 缺乏平整、均衡、穩定或一致的狀態        |  |
| <b>**even-handed**</b> | 對不同人士或立場採用相同標準、不偏袒任何一方的 |  |

# For your original sentence

> “...and **\*\*even now\*\*** I can still remember the atmosphere in his classroom very clearly.”

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*even = 強調「到了現在這麼久之後」仍然如此，是一件值得注意甚至有點出乎意料的事\*\***

Therefore:

> **\*\*even now\*\***

= **\*\*「即使到了現在 / 直到現在這麼久之後仍然」\*\***

Natural translation:

> **\*\*「直到現在，我仍然很清楚記得他課堂上的那種氣氛。」\*\***

And the particularly important pairing in your sentence is:

> **\*\*even now\*\*** → 強調「到了現在竟然仍是如此」

> **\*\*still remember\*\*** → 表示「記憶從過去一直持續到現在」